Consistency

Abi Harrison-Nye

What is it for?

When navigation, buttons, and labels behave consistently across every page, users can build a mental map of the product and move around it confidently.

This matters most for people with cognitive or learning disabilities, memory difficulties, ADHD, anxiety or dyslexia.

How to support it

- Designers can ensure the same components are used for the same actions across every screen
- Content writers can use the same labels for the same things throughout a product. Calling something 'Sign in' on one page and 'Log in' on another creates unnecessary confusion
- Developers can build from a shared component library, so the same element always looks and behaves the same way

Small inconsistencies that feel trivial to one person can be a significant barrier to another.

Useful Links

Understanding SC 3.2.3: Consistent Navigation (Level AA)

Making Content Usable for People with Cognitive and Learning Disabilities